

moving up 52% of the time (with the other 48% continuing down, as the table shows).

Gaps. If a breakout day gap is absent, performance improves. That finding contradicts trading lore, which says gaps help performance. Of course, you're going to have some exceptions, and this is one of them (three, really, one in each column).

If you turn to the statistics in [Chapter 1](#) about gaps, you'll see that they work best in bull markets, especially during downward breakouts. They can also help in bear markets, but it's almost random.